

Day 39 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Political Parties and Political System in India

READING MATERIAL

Closes out Part A Unit IV (Indian Polity) by covering political parties' constitutional/legal basis, the anti-defection law, and how parties are officially recognised as 'National' or 'State' parties.

Q: Does the original (1950) Constitution mention 'political parties'? When did this change?

A: No — the term 'political party' does NOT appear anywhere in the Constitution's original text. It was officially introduced only in 1985, via the 52nd Constitutional Amendment, which added the Tenth Schedule (the anti-defection law).

Q: What is the Tenth Schedule (anti-defection law), and what makes a legislator liable to be disqualified under it?

A: Added by the 52nd Amendment (1985), it disqualifies a member of Parliament or a State Legislature if they EITHER voluntarily give up their political party's membership, OR vote/abstain in the House against their party's whip/directive without obtaining the party's prior permission (and the act isn't condoned by the party within 15 days).

Q: What change did the 91st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2003 make to the anti-defection law?

A: It REMOVED the earlier 'split' exception — previously, if 1/3rd of a party's legislators broke away together, it wasn't treated as defection. After 2003, the ONLY valid exception is a genuine MERGER of the original party with another party, approved by at least 2/3rds of that party's legislators — unilateral splits no longer escape disqualification.

Q: Who decides whether a legislator has defected under the Tenth Schedule, and is that decision final?

A: The Speaker (Lok Sabha/State Assembly) or Chairman (Rajya Sabha/State Council) of the House decides disqualification questions. This decision is SUBJECT TO JUDICIAL REVIEW by courts — the Supreme Court held this in the landmark Kihoto Hollohan case (1992), rejecting the claim that the Speaker's decision was final and beyond judicial scrutiny.

Q: Under the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968, what are the main criteria for 'National Party' recognition?

A: A party qualifies as a National Party if it meets ANY ONE of these: (a) wins at least 2% of Lok Sabha seats, with winning candidates from at least 3 different States; OR (b) is recognised as a 'State Party' in at least 4 States; OR (c) secures at least 6% of valid votes in 4 or more States in a Lok Sabha or Assembly general election, AND wins at least 4 Lok Sabha seats.

Q: What are the criteria for 'State Party' recognition (within a specific State)?

A: EITHER: secures at least 6% of valid votes in that State's Legislative Assembly general election AND wins at least 2 seats there; OR wins at least 3% of the Assembly's total seats (or 3 seats, whichever is more); OR secures at least 6% of valid votes in that State during a Lok Sabha general election AND wins at least 1 Lok Sabha seat from that State.

Q: What statute primarily governs the registration of political parties in India (since there's no separate dedicated 'Political Parties Act')?

A: The Representation of the People Act, 1951 — registration and regulation of political parties is governed under this Act, administered by the Election Commission of India, rather than by a standalone law specifically for political parties.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The term 'political party' was officially introduced into the Constitution by which Amendment?

- A. 42nd Amendment, 1976
- B. 44th Amendment, 1978
- C. 52nd Amendment, 1985 ✓**
- D. 91st Amendment, 2003

Explanation: 52nd Amendment, 1985 (added the Tenth Schedule). [medium, web-research]

2. The anti-defection law is contained in which Schedule of the Constitution?

- A. Eighth Schedule
- B. Ninth Schedule
- C. Tenth Schedule ✓**
- D. Eleventh Schedule

Explanation: Tenth Schedule. [easy, web-research]

3. The 91st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2003 removed which exception from the anti-defection law?

- A. The merger exception
- B. The split exception ✓**
- C. The nominated-member exception
- D. The Speaker's exception

Explanation: The split exception. [hard, web-research]

4. Who decides whether a legislator has incurred disqualification under the Tenth Schedule?

- A. The President
- B. The Election Commission
- C. The Speaker/Chairman of the House ✓**
- D. The Prime Minister

Explanation: The Speaker/Chairman of the House. [medium, web-research]

5. Which landmark case held that the Speaker's decision on disqualification under the Tenth Schedule is subject to judicial review?

- A. Kesavananda Bharati case
- B. Kihoto Hollohan case ✓**
- C. Minerva Mills case
- D. S.R. Bommai case

Explanation: Kihoto Hollohan case, 1992. [hard, web-research]

6. Under the Election Symbols Order, 1968, a party can be recognised as a National Party if it is recognised as a 'State Party' in at least how many States?

- A. 2 States
- B. 3 States
- C. 4 States ✓**
- D. 6 States

Explanation: 4 States. [hard, web-research]

7. To qualify as a National Party via vote-share, a party must secure at least 6% of votes in how many States, while also winning at least how many Lok Sabha seats?

- A. 2 States; 2 seats
- B. 4 States; 4 seats ✓**
- C. 3 States; 3 seats
- D. 6 States; 6 seats

Explanation: 4 States; at least 4 Lok Sabha seats. [hard, web-research]

8. Which Act primarily governs the registration of political parties in India?

- A. The Political Parties Act, 1968
- B. The Representation of the People Act, 1951 ✓**
- C. The Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013
- D. The Citizenship Act, 1955

Explanation: Representation of the People Act, 1951. [medium, web-research]

9. India's political system is generally characterised as a:

- A. Strict two-party system
- B. One-party system
- C. Multi-party system ✓**
- D. No-party system

Explanation: Multi-party system. [easy, authored]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Compound Interest

READING MATERIAL

Compound Interest is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows TNPSC tests the standard CI formula, a useful SI-vs-CI shortcut, AND disguises CI as 'successive percentage change' word problems (depreciation, year-over-year growth) — recognize all three shapes.

Q: Formula: What is the Compound Interest formula, and the shortcut for the DIFFERENCE between SI and CI over 2 years?

A: Amount = $P(1+R/100)^T$, so CI = Amount – P. For exactly 2 years, there's a shortcut: $CI - SI = P \times (R/100)^2$. This avoids computing CI and SI separately when you only need their difference.

Q: Real exam (2022): Find the difference between SI and CI for 2 years on a principal of Rs.5,000 at 8% per annum.

A: Using the shortcut: difference = $P \times (R/100)^2 = 5000 \times (0.08)^2 = 5000 \times 0.0064 = \text{Rs.}32$. (Full check: SI = $5000 \times 8 \times 2/100 = 800$. CI = $5000 \times (1.08^2 - 1) = 5000 \times 0.1664 = 832$. Difference = $832 - 800 = 32$ ✓.)

Q: Real exam (2022): Find the compound interest on Rs.5,000 at 12% per annum for 2 years, compounded annually.

A: CI = $P \times ((1+R/100)^T - 1) = 5000 \times (1.12^2 - 1) = 5000 \times (1.2544 - 1) = 5000 \times 0.2544 = \text{Rs.}1,272$.

Q: Real exam (2025): A sum becomes Rs.13,380 after 3 years and Rs.20,070 after 6 years on compound interest. Find the original sum.

A: The amount after 6 years equals the amount after 3 years multiplied by the SAME growth factor again (since compounding is multiplicative): $(1+R/100)^3 = 20070/13380 = 1.5$. The sum itself: $P = \text{Amount-after-3-years} \div (1+R/100)^3 = 13380 \div 1.5 = \text{Rs.}8,920$.

Q: Real exam (2024): A motorcycle's value 2 years ago was Rs.80,000. It depreciates 4% in the first year, then increases 4% in the second year. Find the present value.

A: Apply each year's change as its own multiplier, in sequence — this is compound interest with a changing/mixed rate: $80,000 \times 0.96$ (first year, -4%) $\times 1.04$ (second year, +4%) = $80,000 \times 0.9984 = \text{Rs.}79,872$. Note the result is slightly LESS than the original Rs.80,000 — a decrease followed by an equal-percentage increase never fully cancels out, since the increase applies to a smaller base.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Find the difference between SI and CI for 2 years on a principal of Rs.8,000 at 5% per annum.

- A. Rs.18
- B. Rs.20 ✓**
- C. Rs.22
- D. Rs.25

Explanation: Difference = $P \times (R/100)^2 = 8000 \times (0.05)^2 = 8000 \times 0.0025 = \text{Rs.}20$. [medium, authored]

2. Find the compound interest on Rs.10,000 at 10% per annum for 2 years, compounded annually.

- A. Rs.2,000
- B. Rs.2,100 ✓**
- C. Rs.2,200
- D. Rs.1,900

Explanation: CI = $10000 \times (1.10^2 - 1) = 10000 \times 0.21 = \text{Rs.}2,100$. [easy, authored]

3. A sum becomes Rs.16,000 after 2 years and Rs.19,360 after 4 years on compound interest. Find the original sum.

- A. Rs.12,500
- B. Rs.13,000
- C. Rs.13,223 ✓**
- D. Rs.14,000

Explanation: $(1+R/100)^2 = 19360/16000 = 1.21$. $P = 16000/1.21 \approx \text{Rs.}13,223$. [hard, authored]

4. A machine valued at Rs.50,000 depreciates by 10% in the first year and a further 10% in the second year. Find its value after 2 years.

- A. Rs.40,000
- B. Rs.40,500 ✓**
- C. Rs.41,000
- D. Rs.39,500

Explanation: $50,000 \times 0.90 \times 0.90 = 50,000 \times 0.81 = \text{Rs.}40,500$. [medium, authored]

5. Find the compound interest on Rs.20,000 at 15% per annum for 2 years, compounded annually.

A. Rs.6,000

B. Rs.6,450 ✓

C. Rs.6,200

D. Rs.6,500

Explanation: $CI = 20000 \times (1.15^2 - 1) = 20000 \times 0.3225 = \text{Rs.}6,450$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "Water — The Elixir of Life" — Sir C.V. Raman

READING MATERIAL

An essay by physicist Sir C.V. Raman arguing that ordinary water, not any imagined magical elixir, is what truly sustains life and civilization — illustrated through the dramatic contrast between the fertile Nile Valley and the barren Libyan Desert, and through practical observations on soil erosion and water conservation.

Q: According to the passage, what is the TRUE 'elixir of life' — and what contrast illustrates its importance most dramatically?

A: Plain water is the true elixir of life. This is illustrated through the contrast between the Libyan Desert (barren, lifeless) and the Valley of the Nile (extremely fertile) — both lying side by side, with water being the ONLY real difference between utter barrenness and abundant fertility.

Q: According to geologists, how was the Nile Valley's fertile soil actually created?

A: By the ANNUAL FLOODING of the Nile river, which deposited silt and nutrients onto the land over time.

Q: What natural feature does the passage compare to 'eyes in a human face', and what broader role does water play in shaping history?

A: Water in the landscape (e.g., lakes, ponds, rainfed tanks) is compared to eyes in a human face — adding life and beauty to the countryside. More broadly, water's role in history is that it SUSTAINS CIVILIZATIONS (not merely shaping climate or geology alone).

Q: What is the main problem the passage associates with soil erosion, and what is its primary cause?

A: Soil erosion DEPLETES MINERALS/nutrients from the land. Its primary cause, per the passage, is heavy rain combined with rapid water run-off (water flowing away too quickly to be absorbed, carrying topsoil with it).

Q: What measures does the passage suggest to prevent soil erosion, and which commonly-assumed measure is NOT actually mentioned?

A: Suggested measures include contour cultivation, constructing bunds, and planting vegetation/afforestation. 'Building dams' is NOT mentioned as a soil-erosion-prevention measure in the passage (a real exam tests this exclusion specifically).

Q: What does the passage identify as the primary natural source of water for plants and animals, and what additional purposes can flowing/moving water serve?

A: Rain or snowfall is identified as the primary source. Moving water can additionally support internal waterways (transport) and hydro-electric power generation.

Q: What connection does the passage draw between afforestation and water conservation, and what is distinctive about rainfed tanks in South India?

A: Afforestation (planting trees/forests) helps PREVENT WATER WASTAGE (by slowing run-off and improving absorption). Rainfed tanks in South India are noted for being silt-laden, which makes them reflect sunlight distinctively.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. According to the passage, what is the true 'elixir of life'?

- A. Immortality
- B. Plain water ✓**
- C. Divine Amrita
- D. Fertile soil

Explanation: Plain water. [easy, web-research]

2. The contrast between the Libyan Desert and the Valley of the Nile is used in the passage to highlight:

- A. The role of agriculture
- B. The power of human civilization
- C. The significance of water ✓**
- D. The history of Egypt

Explanation: The significance of water. [medium, web-research]

3. According to geologists, how was the fertile soil of the Nile Valley created?

- A. By ancient farming techniques
- B. By the annual flooding of the Nile ✓**
- C. Through artificial irrigation channels
- D. By human intervention alone

Explanation: By the annual flooding of the Nile. [medium, web-research]

4. What does the passage compare to 'eyes in a human face'?

- A. Lakes alone
- B. Rivers alone
- C. Rainfed tanks alone

D. Water in the landscape generally ✓

Explanation: Water in the landscape. [medium, web-research]

5. What role does water play in shaping history, per the passage?

- A. It determines the climate
- B. It creates geological formations

C. It sustains civilizations ✓

- D. It defines political boundaries

Explanation: It sustains civilizations. [medium, web-research]

6. What is the main problem associated with soil erosion, per the passage?

- A. It creates deserts
- B. It reduces water availability
- C. It leads to infertile land

D. It depletes minerals ✓

Explanation: It depletes minerals. [medium, web-research]

7. Which of the following is NOT a measure suggested in the passage to prevent soil erosion?

- A. Contour cultivation

B. Building dams ✓

- C. Constructing bunds

- D. Planting vegetation

Explanation: Building dams is not mentioned. [hard, web-research]

8. What does the passage say is the primary source of water for plants and animals?

- A. Groundwater

- B. River water

C. Rain or snowfall ✓

- D. Artesian wells

Explanation: Rain or snowfall. [medium, web-research]

9. What is the main cause of soil erosion, per the passage?

- A. Continuous plowing

B. Heavy rain with rapid water run-off ✓

- C. Overgrazing by animals

- D. Excessive irrigation

Explanation: Heavy rain with rapid water run-off. [medium, web-research]

10. Besides drinking and irrigation, what additional purposes can the movement of water serve, per the passage?

- A. Creating natural barriers

- B. Generating employment

C. Supporting internal waterways and hydro-electric power ✓

- D. Promoting tourism

Explanation: Internal waterways and hydro-electric power. [medium, web-research]